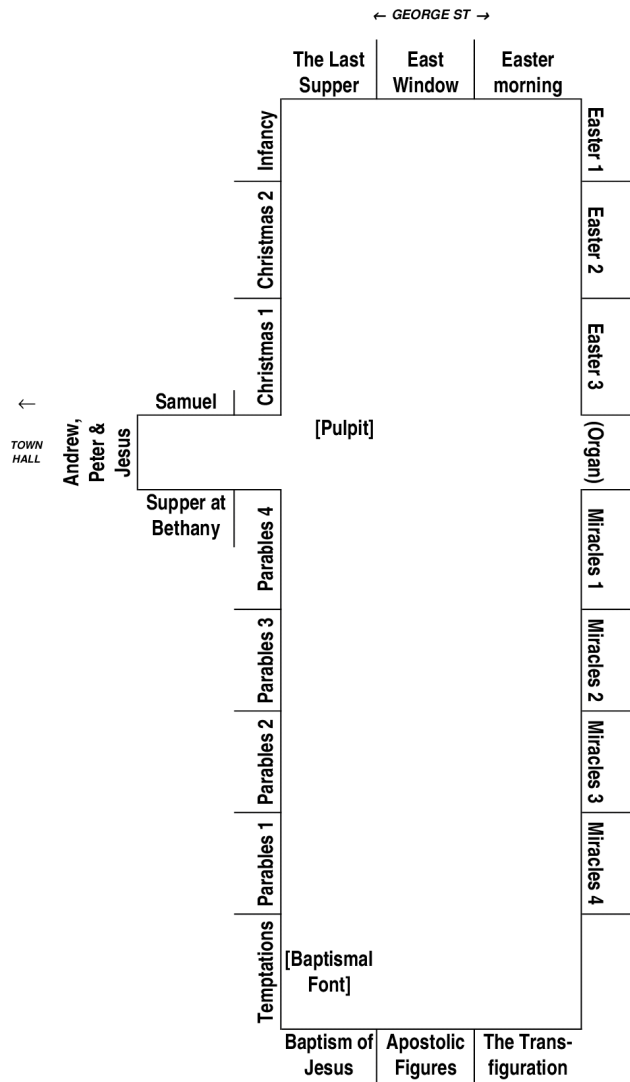




GOSPEL GLASS: A Bible-Reader's Guide to the Windows of St Andrew's Cathedral

Welcome to St Andrew's Cathedral!

Many visitors to the Cathedral express delight in and admiration of the building, particularly the windows.

It is hoped that this resource can help you 'listen in' on the windows as they illustrate the message of Jesus from the Bible.

For your convenience, the windows are labelled as per the map on the left. Orient yourself by noting the direction of Town Hall and George St. We start with 'The Last Supper', top left corner.

Most Bible passages are taken from the English Standard Version. (The King James Version is quoted where embedded in the windows).

Note: In stained glass terminology, a 'light' is a single vertical pane in a 'window'.¹

- John Lew, Sydney, August 2014. (johngracelew@gmail.com)



¹ <http://boppardconservationproject.wordpress.com/about/a-glossary-of-stained-glass-terms/>

1. The Last Supper (John 13:21-30)



After saying these things, Jesus was troubled in his spirit, and testified, “Truly, truly, I say to you, one of you will betray me.” The disciples looked at one another, uncertain of whom he spoke. **One of his disciples, whom Jesus loved, was reclining at table at Jesus' side**, so Simon Peter motioned to him to ask Jesus of whom he was speaking. **So that disciple, leaning back against Jesus**, said to him, “Lord, who is it?” Jesus answered, “It is he to whom I will give this morsel of bread when I have dipped it.” So when he had dipped the morsel, he gave it to Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot. Then after he had taken the morsel, Satan entered into him. Jesus said to him, “What you are going to do, do quickly.” Now no one at the table knew why he said this to him. Some thought that, because **Judas had the moneybag**, Jesus was telling him, “Buy what we need for the

feast,” or that he should give something to the poor. So, after receiving the morsel of bread, he immediately went out. And it was night.

Details to notice, corresponding to the bolded text:

- John (the youngest; has no beard) is pressing against Jesus to ask who the betrayer is;
- Judas opposite Jesus (central window). He is the only person not looking at Jesus; instead he is looking at the money purse with ‘evil’ eyes. His hands are hidden under the table; everybody else’s hands are above the table and visible. His red halo seems to represent his evil scheming.

At this last supper with his disciples, Jesus revealed that one of them would betray him, and knew who it would be. After the meal, Jesus went out to a garden as usual. This time he was met by soldiers, led there by Judas; he had been betrayed. Jesus was arrested and eventually crucified...

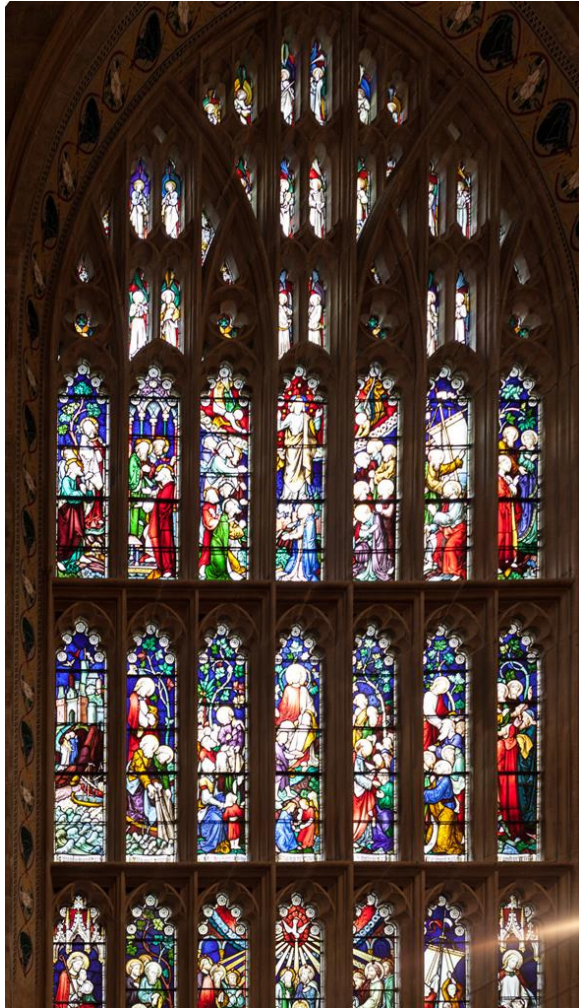
Meaning:

Jesus knew that this would be his last meal with his disciples, his closest friends. He knew he would soon die. And he knew he would be betrayed. He even knew who the traitor would be: one at that very table.

Message:

Jesus’ death didn’t take him by surprise. He could’ve apprehended Judas on the spot. Instead, he knew that these things had to happen. Later in Scripture we learn that Jesus understood these things had to take place in order to fulfil God’s plans: Jesus had to die for the sins of the world. Judas stands in contrast to the faithful disciples; which are you?

2. East Window

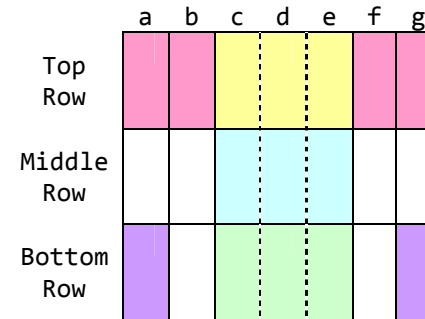


The East Window is the 'main piece' of the Cathedral. Its theme is the life of St. Andrew (the patron saint of Scotland), and covers almost every mention of him in the New Testament. Andrew was selected by Governor Lachlan Macquarie, a Scot.

The way to read this window is to notice that in *each* of the 3 rows, the middle 3 lights are consecutive, forming a single scene. Additionally, in the top row, the first 2 and last 2 lights form a continuous scene.

And in the bottom row, the first and last lights feature Jesus the shepherd, instead of Andrew.

A diagram may help:



At the base of each light is some text related to the scene; most are from the text of the King James Bible. The quoted words are highlighted in the passages that follow.

2.1. East Window - Top Row



[a+b+... (c+d+e) ...+f+g]

The **inner 3 lights** (c, d, e) are taken from Luke 24:51 (KJV)

51 And it came to pass, [Window c:] **while he blessed them,** [Window d:] **he was parted from them,** [Window e:] **and carried up into heaven.**

Meaning: This is known as the Ascension scene. Following his resurrection, Jesus departed his disciples and ascended to heaven. He promised to send them the Holy Spirit.

The **outer lights** – 2 on the left (a, b) and 2 on the right (f, g) – depict a continuous narrative from John 1:37-42. (KJV)

[Window a:] **37** And the two disciples heard him speak, and they followed Jesus. **38** Then Jesus turned, and saw them following, and saith unto them, What seek ye? They said unto him, Rabbi, (which is to say, being interpreted, Master,) **where dwellest thou?** [Window b:] **39** He saith unto them, **Come and see.** They came and saw where he dwelt, and abode with him that day: for it was about the tenth hour. [Window f:] **40** One of the two which heard John speak, and followed him, was Andrew, Simon Peter's brother. **41** He first findeth his own brother Simon, and saith unto him, **We have found the Messiah,** which is, being interpreted, the Christ. [Window g:] **42** And he brought him to Jesus. And when Jesus beheld him, he said, Thou art Simon the son of Jona: **thou shalt be called Cephas,** which is by interpretation, A stone.

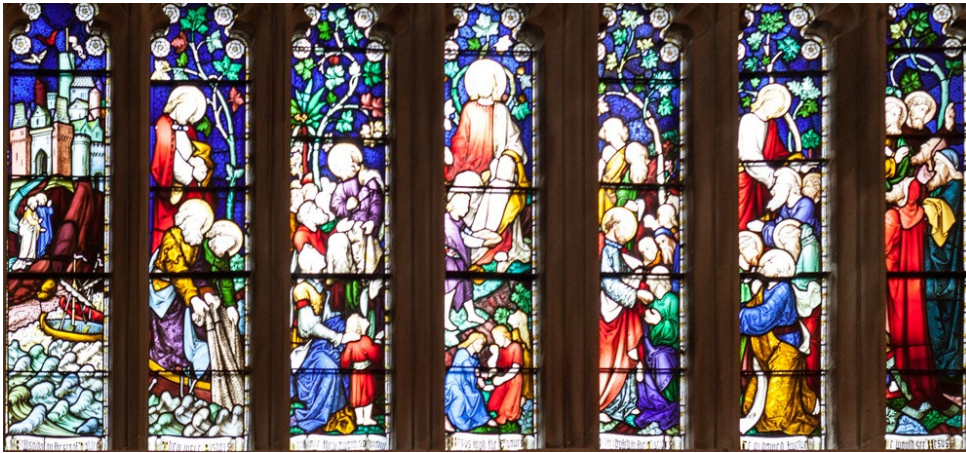
Meaning:

Andrew, after whom this Cathedral is named, is the brother of Peter (who is considered the leader of the apostles). This scene depicts Andrew taking Peter to Jesus, believing him to be the long-awaited Messiah (i.e. Christ) of Israel.

Message:

The disciples recognised the greatness of Jesus, and followed him. 'Following' Jesus Christ is the right response God wants of us.

2.2. East Window - Middle Row



[a, b, (c+d+e), f, g]

The **inner 3 lights** (c, d, e) are taken from John 6:1-14 (KJV)

1 After these things Jesus went over the sea of Galilee, which is the sea of Tiberias. **2** And a great multitude followed him, because they saw his miracles which he did on them that were diseased. **3** And Jesus went up into a mountain, and there he sat with his disciples. **4** And the passover, a feast of the Jews, was nigh. **5** When Jesus then lifted up his eyes, and saw a great company come unto him, he saith unto Philip, Whence shall we buy bread, that these may eat? **6** And this he said to prove him: for he himself knew what he would do. **7** Philip answered him, Two hundred pennyworth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one of them may take a little. **8** [Window c:] One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, saith unto him, **9** There is

a lad here, which hath five barley loaves, and two small fishes: but **what are they among so many?** **10** And Jesus said, Make the men sit down. Now there was much grass in the place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand. **11** [Window d:] And **Jesus took the loaves**; and when he had given thanks, [Window e:] **he distributed to the disciples**, and the disciples to them that were set down; and likewise of the fishes as much as they would. **12** When they were filled, he said unto his disciples, Gather up the fragments that remain, that nothing be lost. **13** Therefore they gathered them together, and filled twelve baskets with the fragments of the five barley loaves, which remained over and above unto them that had eaten. **14** Then those men, when they had seen the miracle that Jesus did, said, This is of a truth that prophet that should come into the world.

The **outer lights** feature Andrew.

a. Label: 'Bethsaida on the sea of Galilee'. No specific biblical scene is depicted here, but John 1:44 states that Bethsaida was the city of Andrew (and Peter).

b. Label: 'They were fishers', referring to Peter and Andrew. (Mark 1:16 or Matthew 4.18-20)

f. Label: 'He ordained twelve', from Mark 3:14. Jesus appointed twelve disciples (Mk 3:13-19... Andrew is named in v. 18).

g. Label: 'We would see Jesus', from John 12:21. Greeks asked to see Jesus (John 12:20-26... Andrew is mentioned in v. 22).

2.3. East Window - Bottom Row:



[a, b, (c+d+e), f, g]

The **inner 3 lights** (c, d, e) feature The Holy Spirit at Pentecost, and are taken from Acts 2:1-4 (KJV)

1 And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. **2** And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. **3** And [Window c:] **there appeared unto them cloven² tongues** like as of fire³, and [Window d:] **it sat upon each of them.** **4** And [Window e:] **they were**

² I.e. 'divided'

³ Notice the tongues of fire resting on their heads.

all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance.

The **outer lights**:

a. Jesus the good shepherd (John 10:1-18)

Label: 'The Lord is my light', possibly Psalm 27:1

b. Label: 'when shall these things be'. Jesus and the fall of Jerusalem. Judging by window 'f' on the right, in which Andrew has a bald top and forehead, this scene is likely to be Mark 13:1-8, esp. vv. 3-4.

f. Label: 'Go' 'Teach all nations' (Matt 28:19) Andrew crosses the Euxine (now called the Black Sea between Europe and Asia). According to Eusebius' "Church History", Book III, ch 1. (probably quoting Origen) Andrew preached to Scythia.

g. Christ in glory (John 21:17)

Note the different decorations in the top and bottom of the first and last lights (a and g). These are 'Jesus the Shepherd' lights.

3. Easter morning (Matthew 28:2-4)



And behold, there was a great earthquake, for an angel of the Lord descended from heaven and came and rolled back the stone and sat on it. His appearance was like lightning, and his clothing white as snow. And for fear of him the guards trembled and became like dead men.

(The window does not adhere strictly to the text, which says that the guards were fearful of the angel. The window depicts them fearful of Jesus himself. Strangely, the sleeping guards reflect the fictitious account in Matt 28:15.)

Note that Jesus is holding a flag on a pole. The red cross symbolises victory over death. This symbol was probably taken from Piero della Francesca's painting, "Resurrection," c.1463.

Notice also the tongues of fire (= Holy Spirit) resting on the angels. Compare with the Pentecost in the bottom row of East Window.

Meaning:

The resurrection of Jesus was a spectacular event, generating fear amongst its immediate witnesses. The message of the angel, though, is 'do not fear.' Those who oppose him, however, have reason to fear.

4. Easter 1 (John 20:1-18)



[a, b, c, d]

Now on the first day of the week Mary Magdalene came to the tomb early, while it was still dark, and saw that the stone had been taken away from the tomb. So she ran and went to Simon Peter and the other disciple, the one whom Jesus loved, and said to them, "They have taken the Lord out of the tomb, and we do not know where they have laid him." [Window d:] **So Peter went out with the other disciple, and they were going toward the tomb. Both of them were running together, but the other disciple outran Peter and reached the tomb first. And stooping to look in, he saw the linen cloths lying there, but he did not go in. Then Simon Peter came, following him, and went into the tomb. He saw the linen cloths lying there, and the face cloth, which had been on Jesus' head, not lying with the linen cloths but folded up in a place by itself.** Then the other disciple, who had reached the tomb first, also went in, and he saw and believed; for as yet they did not understand the Scripture,

that he must rise from the dead. Then the disciples went back to their homes. But Mary stood weeping outside the tomb, and as she wept she stooped to look into the tomb. [Window a:] **And she saw two angels in white, sitting where the body of Jesus had lain, one at the head and one at the feet.** They said to her, "Woman, why are you weeping?" She said to them, "They have taken away my Lord, and I do not know where they have laid him." Having said this, [Window b:] **she turned around and saw Jesus standing, but she did not know that it was Jesus.** Jesus said to her, "Woman, why are you weeping? Whom are you seeking?" Supposing him to be the gardener, she said to him, "Sir, if you have carried him away, tell me where you have laid him, and I will take him away." Jesus said to her, "Mary." She turned and said to him in Aramaic, "Rabboni!" (which means Teacher). Jesus said to her, "Do not cling to me, for I have not yet ascended to the Father; but go to my brothers and say to them, 'I am ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.'" [Window c:] **Mary Magdalene went and announced to the disciples, "I have seen the Lord"**—and that he had said these things to her.

Note, in Window b, Jesus is holding a flag with a red cross, which symbolises victory over death. This symbol can be seen in Piero della Francesca's painting, "Resurrection," c.1463.

Meaning:

The disciples were puzzled by the empty tomb, but rejoiced upon meeting the risen Christ. Do you rejoice that he has risen?

5. Easter 2



[a, b, c, d]

- a. Three Marys at the tomb (Mark 16:1-7... Roman Catholic tradition counts Salome as the third Mary.⁴)

When the Sabbath was past, Mary **Magdalene**, **Mary the mother of James**, and **Salome** bought spices, so that they might go and anoint him. And very early on the first day of the week, when the sun had risen, **they went to the tomb**. And they were saying to one another, “Who will roll away the stone for us from the entrance of the tomb?” And looking up, they saw that the stone had been rolled back— it was very large. And entering the tomb, **they saw a young man sitting on the right side**,

dressed in a white robe, and they were alarmed. And he said to them, “Do not be alarmed. You seek Jesus of Nazareth, who was crucified. He has risen; he is not here. See the place where they laid him. But go, tell his disciples and Peter that he is going before you to Galilee. There you will see him, just as he told you.”

- b. The women see Jesus

This seems to represent a combination of Matthew 28:9
And behold, Jesus met them and said, “Greetings!” And they came up and **took hold of his feet** and worshiped him.

and John 20:16-17.

Jesus said to her, “Mary.” She turned and said to him in Aramaic, “Rabboni!” (which means Teacher). Jesus said to her, “**Do not cling to me**, for I have not yet ascended to the Father; but go to my brothers and say to them, ‘I am ascending to my Father and your Father, to my God and your God.’”

- c. Jesus meets disciples on the road to Emmaus (Luke 24:13-15)

That very day **two of them were going to a village** named Emmaus, about seven miles from Jerusalem, and they were talking with each other about all these things that had happened. While they were talking and discussing together, **Jesus himself drew near** and went with them.

Notice Jesus’ finger, pointing towards the village.

- d. Jesus makes himself known in the meal at Emmaus (Luke 24:28-30)

So they drew near to the village to which they were going. He acted as if he were going farther, but they urged him strongly, saying, “Stay with us, for it is toward evening and the day is now far spent.” So he went in to stay with them. **When he was at table with them, he took the bread and blessed and broke it** and gave it to them.

⁴ http://www.catholic.org/saints/saint.php?saint_id=4962

6. Easter 3 (John 20 & 21)



[a+b, c, d]

The lights in this window depict the resurrected Christ according to the Gospel of John. Jesus is wearing royal robes.

a. Jesus shows his wounds to Thomas (John 20:27) &

b. Thomas believes (John 20:28)

Eight days later, his disciples were inside again, and Thomas was with them. Although the doors were locked, Jesus came and stood among them and said, "Peace be with you." Then he said to Thomas, "Put your finger here, and see my hands; and **put out your hand, and place it in my side.** Do not disbelieve, but believe." **Thomas answered him, "My Lord and my God!"**

c. In Galilee, Jesus tells his followers where to fish (John 21:4-6)

Just as day was breaking, Jesus stood on the shore; yet the disciples did not know that it was Jesus. Jesus said to them, "Children, do you have any fish?" They answered him, "No." He said to them, "**Cast the net on the right side of the boat, and you will find some.**" So they cast it, and now they were not able to haul it in, because of the quantity of fish.

d. Jesus tells Peter "Feed my sheep" (John 21:15-17, 20)

When they had finished breakfast, Jesus said to Simon Peter, "Simon, son of John, do you love me more than these?" He said to him, "Yes, Lord; you know that I love you." He said to him, "Feed my lambs." He said to him a second time, "Simon, son of John, do you love me?" He said to him, "Yes, Lord; you know that I love you." He said to him, "Tend my sheep." He said to him the third time, "Simon, son of John, do you love me?" Peter was grieved because he said to him the third time, "Do you love me?" and he said to him, "Lord, you know everything; you know that I love you." Jesus said to him, "**Feed my sheep...**"... Peter turned and saw **the disciple whom Jesus loved** following them...

- The 'disciple whom Jesus loved' is John (the young man without a beard).
- The ship in the background is the same ship as the window to the left; this scene follows the fish scene. Two other disciples appear in this window; the one next to Jesus is John (the disciple without a beard) – this is 'the disciple whom Jesus loved following them'.
- 'Feed my sheep' – notice the sheep, and the shepherd's staff in Jesus' hand.

Meaning:

In all of these lights note the visible wounds in Jesus' hands and side. Christ has conquered the cross!

9. Miracles 1



[a, b, c, d]

a. Walking on water (Mark 6:47-51)⁵

And when evening came, the boat was out on the sea, and he was alone on the land. And he saw that they were making headway painfully, for the wind was against them. And about the fourth watch of the night **he came to them, walking on the sea**. He meant to pass by them, but when they saw him walking on the sea they thought it was a ghost, and cried out, for they all saw him and were terrified. But immediately

⁵ Also depicted in Matthew 14:25 and John 6:19-21), but I suspect Mark 6, because the KJV says 'And he saw them toiling in rowing', and this picture features an oar.

he spoke to them and said, "Take heart; it is I. Do not be afraid." And he got into the boat with them, and the wind ceased. And they were utterly astounded

b. Healing on the Sabbath

Jesus performed numerous healings on the Sabbath, to the consternation of the Jewish religious leaders (Pharisees). They objected that Jesus was violating holy law by doing 'work' on the holy rest day. Never mind that he was miraculously healing people! This light does not appear to have any particular biblical scene in mind; certainly there was no Sabbath healing involving a young child, as depicted here. By performing healings on the Sabbath, Jesus demonstrated that the day of 'rest' was a day for 'life'. The Pharisees couldn't see this.

c. Curing a leper (Mark 1:40-42)⁶

And a **leper** came to him, imploring him, and kneeling said to him, "If you will, you can make me clean." Moved with pity, **he stretched out his hand and touched him** and said to him, "I will; be clean." And immediately the leprosy left him, and he was made clean.

d. Curing a sick woman (Luke 13:10-15)

Now he was teaching in one of the synagogues on the Sabbath. And behold, there was **a woman who had had a disabling spirit** for eighteen years. She was bent over and could not fully straighten herself. When Jesus saw her, he called her over and said to her, "Woman, you are freed from your disability." And **he laid his hands on her**, and immediately she was made straight, and she glorified God. But the **ruler⁷ of the synagogue**, indignant because Jesus had healed on the Sabbath, said to the people, "There are six days in which work ought to be done. Come on those days and be healed, and not on the Sabbath day." Then the Lord answered him, "You hypocrites!

⁶ Also Matt 8:2-4, Luke 5:12-13

⁷ Depicted without the halo.

10. Miracles 2 (Luke)



[a, b, c, d]

a. Casting out a devil⁸ (Luke 9:38-43)

And behold, a man from the crowd cried out, "Teacher, I beg you to look at my son, for he is my only child. And behold, a spirit seizes him, and he suddenly cries out. It convulses him so that he foams at the mouth, and shatters him, and will hardly leave him. And I begged your disciples to cast it out, but they could not."⁹ Jesus

⁸ Also depicted in Matt 17:14-18 and Mark 9:17-29. I've chosen Luke, to be consistent with the other 3 lights in this window.

⁹ Represented by the disciple behind Jesus.

answered, "O faithless and twisted generation, how long am I to be with you and bear with you? Bring your son here." While he was coming, the demon threw him to the ground and convulsed him. But **Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit and healed the boy**, and gave him back to his father. And all were astonished at the majesty of God.

b. A catch of fish¹⁰ (Luke 5:1-7)¹¹

On one occasion, while the crowd was pressing in on him to hear the word of God, he was standing by the lake of Gennesaret, and he saw two boats by the lake, but the fishermen had gone out of them and were washing their nets. **Getting into one of the boats**, which was Simon's, he asked him to put out a little from the land. And he sat down and taught the people from the boat. And when he had finished speaking, he said to Simon, "Put out into the deep and let down your nets for a catch." And Simon answered, "Master, we toiled all night and took nothing! But at your word **I will let down the nets.**" **And when they had done this, they enclosed a large number of fish, and their nets were breaking.** They signaled to their partners in the other boat to come and help them. And they came and filled both the boats, so that they began to sink.

c. A blind man sees (Luke 18:35-43)¹²

As he drew near to Jericho, a blind man was sitting by the roadside begging. And hearing a crowd going by, he inquired what this meant. They told him, "Jesus of Nazareth is passing by." And he cried out, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!" And those who were in front rebuked him, telling him to be silent. But he cried out all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!" And Jesus stopped and commanded him to be brought to him. And when he came near, he asked him, "What do you want me to do for you?" He said, "Lord, let me recover my sight." **And Jesus said to him, "Recover your sight; your faith has made you well."** **And immediately he recovered his sight** and followed him, glorifying God. And all the people, when they saw it, gave praise to God.

¹⁰ Traditionally known as The Draught of the Fishes.

¹¹ Jesus is in the boat with disciples. In John 21, Jesus is not in the boat.

¹² There are several other blind healings in the Gospels, but I've chosen Luke, to be consistent with the other 3 lights in this window.

d. Healing ten lepers (Luke 17:11-19)

On the way to Jerusalem he was passing along between Samaria and Galilee. And as he entered a village, he was met by ten lepers, who stood at a distance and lifted up their voices, saying, "Jesus, Master, have mercy on us." When he saw them he said to them, "Go and show yourselves to the priests." And as they went they were cleansed. **Then one of them, when he saw that he was healed, turned back, praising God with a loud voice; and he fell on his face at Jesus' feet, giving him thanks.** Now he was a Samaritan. Then Jesus answered, "Were not ten cleansed? **Where are the nine?** Was no one found to return and give praise to God except this foreigner?" And he said to him, "Rise and go your way; your faith has made you well."

This is the grateful one; the nine others did not return to thank Jesus or praise God.

11. Miracles 3 (Matthew)



[a, b, c, d]

a. Curing a centurion's servant (Matt 8:5-13)¹³

When he had entered Capernaum, a **centurion came forward to him**, appealing to him, “Lord, **my servant is lying paralyzed at home**, suffering terribly.” And he said to him, “I will come and heal him.” But the centurion replied, “Lord, I am not worthy to have you come under my roof, but only say the word, and my servant will be healed. For I too am a man under authority, with soldiers under me. And I say to one, ‘Go,’ and he goes, and to another, ‘Come,’ and he comes, and to my servant,

¹³ Not Luke 5:12-13, in which the centurion doesn't *come* to Jesus

‘Do this,’ and he does it.” When Jesus heard this, he marveled and said to those who followed him, “Truly, I tell you, with no one in Israel have I found such faith. I tell you, many will come from east and west and recline at table with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven, while the sons of the kingdom will be thrown into the outer darkness. In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.” And to the centurion Jesus said, “**Go; let it be done for you as you have believed.**” And the servant was healed at that very moment.

b. Curing Peter's mother in law – (Matt 8:14-15)¹⁴

And when Jesus entered Peter's house, **he saw his mother-in-law lying sick with a fever. He touched her hand**, and the fever left her, and she rose and began to serve him.

c. A mute man speaks (Matt 9:32-34)

As they were going away, behold, **a demon-oppressed man who was mute** was brought to him. And when the demon had been cast out, the mute man spoke. And the crowds marveled, saying, “Never was anything like this seen in Israel.” **But the Pharisees said**, “He casts out demons by the prince of demons.”

Note the Pharisees pointing an accusing finger at Jesus.

d. Curing the daughter of a Canaanite woman (Matthew 15:21-28)¹⁵

And Jesus went away from there and withdrew to the district of Tyre and Sidon. And behold, **a Canaanite woman from that region came out** and was crying, “Have mercy on me, O Lord, Son of David; **my daughter** is severely oppressed by a demon.” But he did not answer her a word. And his disciples came and begged him, saying, “Send her away, for she is crying out after us.” He answered, “I was sent only to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.” **But she came and knelt before him**, saying, “Lord, help me.” And he answered, “It is not right to take the children's

¹⁴ Also in Mark 1:30-31 and Luke 4:38-39, but I suggest the Matt passage, since this scene immediately follows light [a] in Matthew.

¹⁵ Also in Mark 7:24-30, but I've chosen Matthew, to be consistent with the other 3 lights in this window.

bread and throw it to the dogs." She said, "Yes, Lord, yet even the dogs eat the crumbs that fall from their masters' table." Then Jesus answered her, "O woman, great is your faith! Be it done for you as you desire." And her daughter was healed instantly.

Note the sick daughter depicted in the thought bubble. The thought bubbles present a symmetry to this window.

Note, in the thought bubble, the demon departing from the daughter.

12. Miracles 4



[a, b, c, d]

a. Healing the paralytic¹⁶ (Mark 2:3-12)¹⁷

And they came, bringing to him **a paralytic carried by four men**. And when they could not get near him because of **the crowd**, **they removed the roof above him**, **and when they had made an opening, they let down the bed on which the paralytic lay**. And when Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralytic, “Son, your

sins are forgiven.” Now some of the scribes were sitting there, questioning in their hearts, “Why does this man speak like that? He is blaspheming! Who can forgive sins but God alone?” And immediately Jesus, perceiving in his spirit that they thus questioned within themselves, said to them, “Why do you question these things in your hearts? Which is easier, to say to the paralytic, ‘Your sins are forgiven,’ or to say, ‘Rise, take up your bed and walk’? But that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins”—he said to the paralytic—“I say to you, rise, pick up your bed, and go home.” And he rose and immediately picked up his bed and went out before them all, so that they were all amazed and glorified God, saying, “We never saw anything like this!”

b. Calming the sea (Mark 4:37-41)¹⁸

And **a great windstorm arose**, and the waves were breaking into the boat, so that the boat was already filling. But he was in the stern, asleep on the cushion. And they woke him and said to him, “Teacher, do you not care that we are perishing?” And he awoke and **rebuked the wind** and said to the sea, “Peace! Be still!” And the wind ceased, and there was a great calm. He said to them, “Why are you so afraid? Have you still no faith?” And they were filled with great fear and said to one another, “Who then is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?”

c. The miracle of loaves and fishes (John 6:4-14)¹⁹

Now the Passover, the feast of the Jews, was at hand. Lifting up his eyes, then, and seeing that **a large crowd was coming toward him**, Jesus said to Philip, “Where are we to buy bread, so that these people may eat?” He said this to test him, for he himself knew what he would do. Philip answered him, “Two hundred denarii worth of bread would not be enough for each of them to get a little.” One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, said to him, “**There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish**, but what are they for so many?” Jesus said, “Have the people sit down.” Now there was much grass in the place. So the men sat down, about five thousand in number. Jesus then took the loaves, and when he had given thanks, he distributed them to those who were seated. So also the fish, as much as they wanted. And when they had eaten their fill, he told his disciples, “Gather up the

¹⁶ Traditionally: ‘Cure of the Man sick of the Palsy’

¹⁷ Or Luke 5:18-25. I’ve arbitrarily chosen Mark. It is not Matthew 9, which doesn’t describe the lowering through the roof.

¹⁸ Or Matt 8:23-27; Luke 8:22-25

¹⁹ I’m choosing this passage because of the presence of the boy in the picture.

leftover fragments, that nothing may be lost.” So they gathered them up and filled twelve baskets with fragments from the five barley loaves left by those who had eaten. When the people saw the sign that he had done, they said, “This is indeed the Prophet who is to come into the world!”

d. Water becomes wine (John 2:1-11)

On the third day there was a wedding at Cana in Galilee, and the mother of Jesus was there. Jesus also was invited to the wedding with his disciples. When the wine ran out, the mother of Jesus said to him, “They have no wine.” And Jesus said to her, “Woman, what does this have to do with me? My hour has not yet come.” His mother said to the servants, “Do whatever he tells you.” Now there were six **stone water jars** there for the Jewish rites of purification, each holding twenty or thirty gallons. Jesus said to the servants, “Fill the jars with water.” And they filled them up to the brim. And he said to them, “**Now draw some out and take it to the master of the feast.**” So they took it. When the master of the feast tasted the water now become wine, and did not know where it came from (though the servants who had drawn the water knew), the master of the feast called the bridegroom and said to him, “Everyone serves the good wine first, and when people have drunk freely, then the poor wine. But you have kept the good wine until now.” This, the first of his signs, Jesus did at Cana in Galilee, and manifested his glory. And his disciples believed in him.

13. The Transfiguration (Matthew 17:1-6)



[Elijah, Jesus, Moses]
[Peter, James, John²⁰]

And after six days **Jesus** took with him **Peter** and **James**, and **John** his brother, and led them up a high mountain by themselves. And he was **transfigured** before them, and his face shone like the sun, and his clothes became white as light. And behold, there appeared to them **Moses** and **Elijah**, talking with him. And Peter said to Jesus, “Lord, it is good that we are here. If you wish, I will make three tents here, one for you and one for Moses and one for Elijah.” He was still speaking when, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them, and a voice from the cloud said, “**This is my beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased**; listen to him.” When the disciples heard this, **they fell on their faces and were terrified**.

Notes:

Elijah holds a scroll with his name ‘Elias’ (as per King James Version).

Moses is holding the stone tablet of the Ten Commandments (I to X)
Moses’ horns come from a mistranslation (in the Latin Vulgate) of an uncommon Hebrew word which, in context, intended to mean that Moses’ face ‘shone’ after speaking with God. (Exodus 34:27-35)

In Moses’ left hand is his staff (see Exodus).

Scroll of the left angel: ‘hic est Filius’, Latin for ‘This is my beloved Son’.
Scroll of the middle angel: ‘meus in quo mihi’, Latin for ‘in whom I’.
Scroll of the right angel: ‘complarie’, but is probably intended to be ‘conplacuit’, Latin for ‘pleased’.

Thus the angels’ scrolls depict the voice of God in Mat 17:5
‘hic est Filius meus dilectus in quo mihi bene conplacuit ipsum audite’
This identifies the passage as Matthew 17, rather than Mark 9 or Luke 9.

Message:

Much as we esteem great Old Testament characters such as Elijah and Moses, it is the Son of God whom they point us to.

²⁰ Peter would have the beard. I’m not sure how to distinguish James and John.

14. Apostolic figures ²¹

Top row:



Simon: a saw. According to legend, he was martyred by being sawed into pieces.

James the Less: Long-standing tradition identifies James the Less as the son of Alphaeus

Andrew: a transverse cross. It was on this kind of cross that Saint Andrew was crucified in Greece

Barnabas

Matthias

Jude: a halberd. Persians executed him with this long-handled and ax-like weapon.

Middle row:



Thomas

James (the Great), a fuller's club. After being cast from the Temple roof Saint James was beaten to death with such a club.

John the Baptist

Stephen, palm branch (traditionally signifies martyrs) and a stone(?). (He was stoned to death in Acts 7:58)

Philip, latin cross. Saint Philip is pictured carrying the cross of Christ, which was the theme of his preaching.

Bartholomew, a knife. The traditional symbol for Saint Bartholomew, used to flay him alive.

²¹ http://www.catholic.org/saints/saint.php?saint_id=8

Bottom row:



Peter: crossed keys. Silver and gold keys signify Saint Peter's divinely-given power of binding and loosing.

Matthew, Mark, Luke and John hold quills, denoting them as Gospel authors. They are presented in the order they appear in the Bible.

“Christian tradition has long connected the authors of the four canonical Gospels (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John) with the four "living creatures" that surround God's throne, as described in Rev 4:7”, Ezek 1:10, 10:14.

Matthew: angel signifies that Christians should use their reason for salvation.

Mark: winged lion signifies that Christians should be courageous on the path of salvation.

Luke: The ox signifies that Christians should be prepared to sacrifice themselves in following Christ.

John: youngest apostle = no beard. Eagle.

Peter precedes, possibly because he supplied the oral tradition to Mark. Paul is last, because chronologically he was the latter prominent writer.

Paul: sword (Sword of the Spirit? Eph 6.17)

15. The Baptism of Jesus (John 1:29-34)



The next day he [*John the Baptist*] saw Jesus coming toward him, and said, “**Behold, the Lamb of God**, who takes away the sin of the world! This is he of whom I said, ‘After me comes a man who ranks before me, because he was before me.’ I myself did not know him, but for this purpose I came baptizing with water, that he might be revealed to Israel.” And John bore witness: “I saw **the Spirit descend from heaven like a dove**, and it remained on him. I myself did not know him, but he who sent me to baptize with water said to me, ‘He on whom you see the Spirit descend and remain, this is he who baptizes with the Holy Spirit.’ And I have seen and have borne witness that this is the Son of God.”

The baptismal font is symbolically placed directly below this window.

This important event is recorded in all four Gospels, but the words coming off the staff held by John the Baptist, ‘ECCE AGNUS DEI’, are Latin for ‘Behold the Lamb of God’, from John’s Gospel, chapter 1.

The theme of ‘Son of God’ continues onto Window 16 (next).

Meaning:

John the Baptist was the last of the Prophets. His main mission in life was to point the world to the Son of God. Calling Jesus the Lamb of God prophesies that he would be sacrificed for the sins of the world.

16. Three temptations of Jesus (Matthew 4:1-11)²²



²² The corresponding passage in Luke 4:1-14 does not mention the angels.

Then Jesus was led up by **the Spirit** into the wilderness to be tempted by the **devil**. And after fasting forty days and forty nights, he was hungry.

[Window c:] And the tempter came and said to him, “If you are the Son of God, command **these stones** to become loaves of bread.” But he answered, “It is written, “‘Man shall not live by bread alone, but **by every word that comes from the mouth of God.**’”²³

[Window a:] Then the devil took him to the holy city and set him on **the pinnacle of the temple** and said to him, “If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down, for it is written, “‘He will command his angels concerning you,’ and “‘On their hands they will bear you up, lest you strike your foot against a stone.’” Jesus said to him, “Again it is written, ‘You shall not put the Lord your God to the test.’”²⁴

[Window b:] Again, the devil took him to **a very high mountain** and showed him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory. And he said to him, “All these I will give you, if you will fall down and worship me.” Then Jesus said to him, “Be gone, Satan! For it is written, “‘You shall worship the Lord your God and him only shall you serve.’”²⁵

Then the devil left him, and behold, **angels came** and were ministering to him.

Why are the temptations displayed out of order? Possibly so that the third temptation, in which the devil finally departs from Jesus, is positioned in the central light to magnify his ‘victory’... notice how Jesus is elevated in this picture.

Notice the devil’s grey halo = fallen angel?

Meaning:

Jesus was led to the wilderness for 40 days and nights, after which he withstood the temptations of the devil.

²³ Deuteronomy 8:3

²⁴ Deuteronomy 6:16

²⁵ Deuteronomy 6:13

The 40 days and nights represent the 40 years that Israel was punished in the wilderness for.²⁶ Where Israel failed, Jesus is the true people of God. Note that Jesus fought the devil with the word of God.

²⁶ Numbers 14:26-35

17. Parables 1 (Luke)



[a, b, c, d]

a. The sower (Luke 8:4-15)²⁷

And when a great crowd was gathering and people from town after town came to him, he said in a parable, “**A sower went out to sow his seed.** And as he sowed, some fell along the **path** and was trampled underfoot, and the **birds** of the air devoured it. And some fell on the **rock**, and as it grew up, it **withered** away, because it had no moisture. And some fell among **thorns**, and the thorns grew up with it and choked it. And some fell into **good soil and grew and yielded a hundredfold.**” As he said these things, he called out, “He who has ears to hear, let him hear.” And when his disciples asked him what this parable meant, he said, “To

²⁷ This parable is also featured in Mt 13 and Mk 4. Lk 8 has been selected because the three other lights feature parables that are recorded in Luke only.

you it has been given to know the secrets of the kingdom of God, but for others they are in parables, so that ‘seeing they may not see, and hearing they may not understand.’ Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God. The ones along the path are those who have heard; then the devil comes and takes away the word from their hearts, so that they may not believe and be saved. And the ones on the rock are those who, when they hear the word, receive it with joy. But these have no root; they believe for a while, and in time of testing fall away. And as for what fell among the thorns, they are those who hear, but as they go on their way they are choked by the cares and riches and pleasures of life, and their fruit does not mature. As for that in the good soil, they are those who, hearing the word, hold it fast in an honest and good heart, and bear fruit with patience.

b. The Pharisee and the tax collector (Lk 18:10-14)

“Two men went up into the temple to pray, one a **Pharisee** and the other a **tax collector**. The Pharisee, **standing by himself**, prayed thus: ‘God, I thank you that I am not like other men, extortioners, unjust, adulterers, or even like this tax collector. I fast twice a week; I give tithes of all that I get.’ But the tax collector, **standing far off**, would not even lift up his eyes to heaven, but beat his breast, saying, ‘God, be merciful to me, a sinner!’ I tell you, this man went down to his house justified, rather than the other. For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, but the one who humbles himself will be exalted.”

c. The good Samaritan (Lk 10:30-37)

Jesus replied, “A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and he fell among robbers, who **stripped him and beat him** and departed, leaving him **half dead**. Now by chance a **priest** was going down that road, and when he saw him he **passed by on the other side**. So likewise a **Levite**, when he came to the place and saw him, **passed by on the other side**. But a **Samaritan**, as he journeyed, came to where he was, and when he saw him, he had compassion. He went to him and **bound up his wounds**, pouring on oil and wine. Then he set him on his own animal and brought him to an inn and took care of him. And the next day he took out two denarii and gave them to the innkeeper, saying, ‘Take care of him, and whatever more you spend, I will repay you when I come back.’ Which of these three, do you think, proved to be a neighbor to the man who fell among the robbers?” He said,

"The one who showed him mercy." And Jesus said to him, "You go, and do likewise."

d. The lost son (Lk 15:11-32)

And he said, "There was a man who had two sons. And the younger of them said to his father, 'Father, give me the share of property that is coming to me.' And he divided his property between them. Not many days later, the younger son gathered all he had and took a journey into a far country, and there he squandered his property in reckless living. And when he had spent everything, a severe famine arose in that country, and he began to be in need. So he went and hired himself out to one of the citizens of that country, who sent him into his fields to feed pigs. And he was longing to be fed with the pods that the pigs ate, and no one gave him anything. "But when he came to himself, he said, 'How many of my father's hired servants have more than enough bread, but I perish here with hunger! I will arise and go to my father, and I will say to him, "Father, I have sinned against heaven and before you. I am no longer worthy to be called your son. Treat me as one of your hired servants."' And he arose and came to his father. But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and felt compassion, and ran and embraced him and kissed him. **And the son said to him, 'Father, I have sinned against heaven and before you. I am no longer worthy to be called your son.'** But the father said to his servants, 'Bring quickly the best robe, and put it on him, and put a ring on his hand, and shoes on his feet. And bring the fattened calf and kill it, and let us eat and celebrate. For this my son was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found.' And they began to celebrate. "Now his older son was in the field, and as he came and drew near to the house, he heard music and dancing. And he called one of the servants and asked what these things meant. And he said to him, 'Your brother has come, and your father has killed the fattened calf, because he has received him back safe and sound.' **But he was angry and refused to go in.** His father came out and entreated him, but he answered his father, 'Look, these many years I have served you, and I never disobeyed your command, yet you never gave me a young goat, that I might celebrate with my friends. But when this son of yours came, who has devoured your property with prostitutes, you killed the fattened calf for him!' And he said to him, 'Son, you are always with me, and all that is mine is yours. It was fitting to celebrate and be glad, for this your brother was dead, and is alive; he was lost, and is found.'"

18. Parables 2



[a, b, c, d]

a. The unjust judge (Lk 18:2-8)

He said, "In a certain city there was a **judge** who neither feared God nor respected man. And there was a **widow** in that city who kept coming to him and saying, 'Give me justice against my adversary.' For a while he **refused**, but afterward he said to himself, 'Though I neither fear God nor respect man, yet because this widow keeps bothering me, I will give her justice, so that she will not beat me down by her continual coming.'" And the Lord said, "Hear what the unrighteous judge says. And will not God give justice to his elect, who cry to him day and night? Will he delay long over them? I tell you, he will give justice to them speedily. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on earth?"

b. The king's banquet (Lk 14:16-24)

But he said to him, "A **man** once gave a great **banquet** and invited many. And at the time for the banquet he sent his servant to say to those who had been invited, 'Come, for everything is now ready.' But they all alike began to make excuses. The first said to him, 'I have bought a field, and I must go out and see it. Please have me excused.' And another said, 'I have bought five yoke of oxen, and I go to examine them. Please have me excused.' And another said, 'I have married a wife, and therefore I cannot come.' So the servant came and reported these things to his master. Then the master of the house became angry and said to his servant, '**Go out quickly to the streets and lanes of the city, and bring in the poor and crippled and blind and lame.**' And the servant said, 'Sir, what you commanded has been done, and still there is room.' And the master said to the servant, '**Go out to the highways and hedges and compel people to come in, that my house may be filled.** For I tell you, none of those men who were invited shall taste my banquet.'"

c. The unjust steward (Luke 16:1-10)

He also said to the disciples, "There was a **rich man** who had a **manager**, and charges **were brought to him that this man was wasting his possessions**. And he called him and said to him, 'What is this that I hear about you? Turn in the account of your management, for you can no longer be manager.' And the manager said to himself, 'What shall I do, since my master is taking the management away from me? I am not strong enough to dig, and I am ashamed to beg. I have decided what to do, so that when I am removed from management, people may receive me into their houses.' So, summoning his master's debtors one by one, he said to the first, 'How much do you owe my master?' He said, 'A hundred measures of oil.' He said to him, 'Take your bill, and sit down quickly and write fifty.' Then he said to another, 'And how much do you owe?' He said, 'A hundred measures of wheat.' He said to him, 'Take your bill, and write eighty.' The master commended the dishonest manager for his shrewdness. For the sons of this world are more shrewd in dealing with their own generation than the sons of light. And I tell you, make friends for yourselves by means of unrighteous wealth, so that when it fails they may receive you into the eternal dwellings. "One who is faithful in a very little is also faithful in much, and one who is dishonest in a very little is also dishonest in much.

d. The wedding garment (Mt 22:1-14)

And again Jesus spoke to them in parables, saying, "The kingdom of heaven may be compared to **a king who gave a wedding feast for his son**, and sent his servants to call those who were invited to the wedding feast, but they would not come. Again he sent other servants, saying, 'Tell those who are invited, "See, I have prepared my dinner, my oxen and my fat calves have been slaughtered, and everything is ready. Come to the wedding feast."' But they paid no attention and went off, one to his farm, another to his business, while the rest seized his servants, treated them shamefully, and killed them. The king was angry, and he sent his troops and destroyed those murderers and burned their city. Then he said to his servants, 'The wedding feast is ready, but those invited were not worthy. Go therefore to the main roads and invite to the wedding feast as many as you find.' And those servants went out into the roads and gathered all whom they found, both bad and good. So the wedding hall was filled with guests. "But when the king came in to look at the guests, **he saw there a man who had no wedding garment. And he said to him, 'Friend, how did you get in here without a wedding garment?' And he was speechless. Then the king said to the attendants, 'Bind him hand and foot and cast him into the outer darkness. In that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.'** For many are called, but few are chosen."

19. Parables 3 (Luke)



[a, b, c, d]

a. The barren fig tree (Luke 13:6-9)

And he told this parable: “A **man** had a **fig tree** planted in his vineyard, and he came seeking fruit on it and found none. And he said to the **vinedresser**, ‘Look, for three years now **I have come seeking fruit on this fig tree, and I find none. Cut it down.** Why should it use up the ground?’ And he answered him, ‘Sir, let it alone this year also, until I dig around it and put on manure. Then if it should bear fruit next year, well and good; but if not, you can cut it down.’”

b. The ten talents (Luke 19:12-28)²⁸

He said therefore, “A **nobleman** went into a far country to receive for himself a **kingdom** and then return. Calling ten of his servants, he gave them ten minas, and said to them, ‘Engage in business until I come.’ But his citizens hated him and sent a delegation after him, saying, ‘We do not want this man to reign over us.’ When he returned, having received the kingdom, he ordered these servants to whom he had given the money to be called to him, that he might know what they had gained by doing business. The first came before him, saying, ‘Lord, your mina has made ten minas more.’ And he said to him, ‘Well done, good servant! Because you have been faithful in a very little, you shall have authority over ten cities.’ And the second came, saying, ‘Lord, your mina has made five minas.’ And he said to him, ‘And you are to be over five cities.’ Then another came, saying, ‘Lord, here is your mina, which I kept laid away in a handkerchief; for I was afraid of you, because you are a severe man. You take what you did not deposit, and reap what you did not sow.’ **He said to him, ‘I will condemn you with your own words, you wicked servant! You knew that I was a severe man, taking what I did not deposit and reaping what I did not sow? Why then did you not put my money in the bank, and at my coming I might have collected it with interest?’** And he said to those who stood by, ‘Take the mina from him, and give it to the one who has the ten minas.’ And they said to him, ‘Lord, he has ten minas!’ ‘I tell you that to everyone who has, more will be given, but from the one who has not, even what he has will be taken away. But as for these enemies of mine, who did not want me to reign over them, bring them here and slaughter them before me.’” And when he had said these things, he went on ahead, going up to Jerusalem.

c. The lost coin (Luke 15:8-10)

“Or what woman, having ten silver coins, **if she loses one coin, does not light a lamp and sweep the house and seek diligently until she finds it? And when she**

²⁸ Although the early documents label this window ‘The Ten Talents’, which in the King James Version refers to Matthew 25:14-30, the light depicts the nobleman wearing a crown, and so it more likely refers to the parable in Luke 19, in which the nobleman received a kingdom.

has found it, she calls together her friends and neighbors, saying, 'Rejoice with me, for I have found the coin that I had lost.' Just so, I tell you, there is joy before the angels of God over one sinner who repents."

d. A rich man and Lazarus (Luke 16:19-31)

"There was a **rich man who was clothed in purple and fine linen and who feasted sumptuously every day**. And at his gate was laid **a poor man named Lazarus**, covered with sores, who desired to be fed with what fell from the rich man's table. Moreover, even **the dogs came and licked his sores**. The poor man died and was carried by the angels to Abraham's side. The rich man also died and was buried, and in Hades, being in torment, he lifted up his eyes and saw Abraham far off and Lazarus at his side. And he called out, 'Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus to dip the end of his finger in water and cool my tongue, for I am in anguish in this flame.' But Abraham said, 'Child, remember that you in your lifetime received your good things, and Lazarus in like manner bad things; but now he is comforted here, and you are in anguish. And besides all this, between us and you a great chasm has been fixed, in order that those who would pass from here to you may not be able, and none may cross from there to us.' And he said, 'Then I beg you, father, to send him to my father's house— for I have five brothers—so that he may warn them, lest they also come into this place of torment.' But Abraham said, 'They have Moses and the Prophets; let them hear them.' And he said, 'No, father Abraham, but if someone goes to them from the dead, they will repent.' He said to him, 'If they do not hear Moses and the Prophets, neither will they be convinced if someone should rise from the dead.'"

20. Parables 4



[a+b, c, d]

a, b. The good shepherd²⁹ (Luke 15:3-7)³⁰

²⁹ Note that Jesus himself is depicted as the shepherd in these 2 lights!

³⁰ The corresponding passage in Matt 18:12-13 does not describe the shepherd laying the sheep on his shoulders.

So he told them this parable: "What man of you, having a **hundred sheep**, if he has lost one of them, does not leave the ninety-nine in the open country, and **go after the one that is lost**, until he finds it? And when he has found it, **he lays it on his shoulders**, rejoicing. And when he comes home, he calls together his friends and his neighbors, saying to them, 'Rejoice with me, for I have found my sheep that was lost.' Just so, I tell you, there will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who need no repentance.

c. The two sons³¹ (Matt 21:28-32)

"What do you think? A **man had two sons**. And he went to the first and said, 'Son, go and work in the **vineyard** today.' And he answered, 'I will not,' but afterward he changed his mind and went. And he went to the other son and said the same. And he answered, 'I go, sir,' but did not go. Which of the two did the will of his father?" They said, "The first." Jesus said to them, "Truly, I say to you, the tax collectors and the prostitutes go into the kingdom of God before you. For John came to you in the way of righteousness, and you did not believe him, but the tax collectors and the prostitutes believed him. And even when you saw it, you did not afterward change your minds and believe him.

Note the man with the crossed arms on the right; is he the son who said 'I will not'?

d. The wicked tenants³² (Matthew 21:33-46)³³

"Hear another parable. There was a **master** of a house who planted a **vineyard** and put a fence around it and dug a winepress in it and built a tower and leased it to **tenants**, and went into another country. When the season for **fruit** drew near, he sent his servants to the tenants to get his fruit. And the tenants took his servants and beat one, killed another, and stoned another. Again he sent other servants, more than the first. And they did the same to them. **Finally he sent his son to them, saying, 'They will respect my son.'** But when the tenants saw the son, they said to themselves, '**This is the heir. Come, let us kill him and have his inheritance.**'

³¹ but why are there 4 in the picture?

³² Traditionally 'husbandmen'.

³³ Also Mark 12:1-12 & Luke 20:9-20, but Matt 21:33 immediately follows light [c].

And they took him and threw him out of the vineyard and killed him. When therefore the owner of the vineyard comes, what will he do to those tenants?" They said to him, "He will put those wretches to a miserable death and let out the vineyard to other tenants who will give him the fruits in their seasons." Jesus said to them, "Have you never read in the Scriptures:

“‘The stone that the builders rejected has become the cornerstone; this was the Lord's doing, and it is marvelous in our eyes’?

Therefore I tell you, the kingdom of God will be taken away from you and given to a people producing its fruits. And the one who falls on this stone will be broken to pieces; and when it falls on anyone, it will crush him.” When the chief priests and the Pharisees heard his parables, they perceived that he was speaking about them. And although they were seeking to arrest him, they feared the crowds, because they held him to be a prophet.

21. Supper at Bethany (John 12:1-8)³⁴



Six days before the Passover, Jesus therefore came to Bethany, where Lazarus was, whom Jesus had raised from the dead. So they gave a dinner for him there. **Martha served,** and **Lazarus** was one of those reclining with him at table. **Mary therefore took a pound of expensive ointment made from pure nard, and anointed the feet of Jesus and wiped his feet with her hair.** The house was filled with the fragrance of the perfume. But Judas Iscariot, one of his disciples (he who was about to betray him), said, “Why was this ointment not sold for three hundred denarii and given to the poor?” He said this, not because he cared about the poor, but because he was a thief, and **having charge of the moneybag** he used to help himself to what was put into it. Jesus said, “Leave her alone, so that she may keep it for the day of my burial. For the poor you always have with you, but you do not always have me.”³⁵

Is Judas on the left, grasping the moneybag?

Who is the man on the right, cupping his ear to hear Jesus?

Lazarus' name is written on his halo; he is the man opposite Jesus, holding a cup of red wine.

Meaning:

This dinner was given for Lazarus, whom Jesus had raised from the dead.³⁶

After this, the Jewish leaders, in their utter corruption, planned to kill Lazarus as well as Jesus! The corrupt Judas will soon play into their hands.

³⁴ not the Lord's supper!

³⁵ Jesus' words, underlined, are quoted at the bottom of the window, across the three lights, from the King James Version: “Let her alone: against the day of My burying I hath she kept this. For the poor always ye have I with you; but me ye have not always”

³⁶ John 11:38-44

22 (Andrew, Peter and Jesus). Top Row



[a, b, c]

a. Behold the lamb of God (John 1:29-36)

The next day he saw Jesus coming toward him, and said, “Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world! This is he of whom I said, ‘After me comes a man who ranks before me, because he was before me.’ I myself did not know him, but for this purpose I came baptizing with water, that he might be revealed to Israel.” And John bore witness: “I saw the Spirit descend from heaven like a dove, and it remained on him. I myself did not know him, but he who sent me to baptize with water said to me, ‘He on whom you see the Spirit descend and remain, this is he who baptizes with the Holy Spirit.’ And I have seen and have borne witness that this is the Son of God.” **The next day again John was standing with two of his disciples, and he looked at Jesus as he walked by and said, “Behold, the Lamb of God!”**

b. Call of St Andrew³⁷ (Matthew 4:18-20)³⁸

While walking by the Sea of Galilee, he saw two brothers, Simon (who is called Peter) and **Andrew** his brother, casting a net into the sea, for they were fishermen. And he said to them, “Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.” Immediately they left their nets and followed him.

c. Call of St Peter (Luke 5:1-11)³⁹

On one occasion, while the crowd was pressing in on him to hear the word of God, he was standing by the lake of Gennesaret, and he saw two boats by the lake, but the fishermen had gone out of them and were washing their nets. **Getting into one of the boats, which was Simon's**, he asked him to put out a little from the land. And he sat down and taught the people from the boat. And when he had finished speaking, he said to Simon, “Put out into the deep and let down your nets for a catch.” And Simon answered, “Master, we toiled all night and took nothing! But at your word I will let down the nets.” And when they had done this, they enclosed a large number of fish, and their nets were breaking. They signaled to their partners in

³⁷ note that Andrew has a bald top

³⁸ Also Mk 1:16-18

³⁹ Also Mt 4.18-20 & Mk 1:16-18, but only Lk 5 mentions Peter Simon.

the other boat to come and help them. And they came and filled both the boats, so that they began to sink. But when Simon Peter saw it, he fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, "Depart from me, for I am a sinful man, O Lord." For he and all who were with him were astonished at the catch of fish that they had taken, and so also were James and John, sons of Zebedee, who were partners with Simon. **And Jesus said to Simon, "Do not be afraid; from now on you will be catching men."** And when they had brought their boats to land, they left everything and followed him.

22. Middle Row



[a, b, c]

a. Receive ye the Holy Ghost (John 20:19-22)

On the evening of that day, the first day of the week, the doors being locked where the disciples were for fear of the Jews, **Jesus came and stood among them** and said to them, "Peace be with you." When he had said this, he showed them his hands and his side. Then the disciples were glad when they saw the Lord. Jesus said to them again, "Peace be with you. As the Father has sent me, even so I am sending you." And when he had said this, he breathed on them and said to them, "**Receive the Holy Spirit.**"

b. Day of Pentecost (Acts 2:1-4)

When the day of Pentecost arrived, they were all together in one place. And suddenly there came from heaven a sound like a mighty rushing wind, and it filled the entire house where they were sitting. And **divided tongues as of fire appeared to them and rested on each one of them.** And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues as the Spirit gave them utterance.

c. St Andrew preaching⁴⁰

⁴⁰ This is not a scene from the Bible, nor could I identify it with any specific church tradition. I conclude it is a generic scene depicting this Cathedral's namesake preaching the Word of God.

22. Bottom Row (Crucifixions)⁴¹



[a, b, c]

⁴¹ You need to stand back to see this row, otherwise look from Town Hall Square when it is illuminated from inside.

a. Andrew crucified on diagonal cross

“Was the brother of Peter. He preached the gospel to many Asiatic nations; but on his arrival at Edessa he was taken and crucified on a cross, the two ends of which were fixed transversely in the ground. Hence the derivation of the term, St. Andrew's Cross.” (Foxe's book of martyrs: ch 1, VII.)⁴²

“A tradition developed that Andrew had been crucified on a cross of the form called Crux decussata (X-shaped cross, or "saltire"), now commonly known as a "Saint Andrew's Cross" — supposedly at his own request, as he deemed himself unworthy to be crucified on the same type of cross as Jesus had been.”⁴³

b. Jesus crucified (John 19)

Two details identify this depiction as from John's Gospel: the inscription 'INRI' (v. 19-20), and the piercing with the spear (v. 34).

The acronym INRI represents the Latin inscription IESVS·NAZARENVS·REX·IVDÆORVM (Jesus Nazarene, King of the Jews), in English reads as "Jesus the Nazarene, King of the Jews".⁴⁴

c. Peter crucified upside down (under Nero)

“By this, Peter, perceiving his suffering to be understood, returned into the city. Jerome saith that he was crucified, his head being down and his feet upward, himself so requiring, because he was (he said) unworthy to be crucified after the same form and manner as the Lord was.” (Foxe's book of martyrs, chapter I, IX)⁴⁵

⁴² <http://www.ccel.org/f/foxe/martyrs/fox101.htm>

⁴³ http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Andrew_the_Apostle

⁴⁴ http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jesus,_King_of_the_Jews

⁴⁵ <http://www.ccel.org/ccel/foxe/martyrs/files/fox101.htm>

24. The birth of Jesus (Luke 1:26-2:20)



[a, b, c, d]

a. The Annunciation – Luke 1:26-33

In the sixth month the angel **Gabriel** was sent from God to a city of Galilee named Nazareth, to a virgin betrothed to a man whose name was Joseph, of the house of David. And the virgin's name was **Mary**. And he came to her and said, “**Greetings, O favored one**, the Lord is with you!” But she was greatly troubled at the saying, and tried to discern what sort of greeting this might be. And the angel said to her, “Do not be afraid, Mary, for you have found favor with God. And behold, you will conceive in your womb and bear a son, and you shall call his name Jesus. He will be great and will be called the Son of the Most High. And the Lord God will give to him the throne of his father David,

and he will reign over the house of Jacob forever, and of his kingdom there will be no end.”

The ribbon flowing from the foot of the angel says "ave gratia plena", probably from the Latin 'have gratia plena', which literally means “Hail, full of grace”. In the modern ESV it is translated as ‘Greetings, O favoured one’.

b. Mary and Elizabeth meet (Luke 1:39-45)

In those days **Mary** arose and went with haste into the hill country, to a town in Judah, and she entered the house of Zechariah and **greeted Elizabeth**. And when Elizabeth heard the greeting of Mary, the baby leaped in her womb. And Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit, and she exclaimed with a loud cry, “Blessed are you among women, and blessed is the fruit of your womb! And why is this granted to me that the mother of my Lord should come to me? For behold, when the sound of your greeting came to my ears, the baby in my womb leaped for joy. And blessed is she who believed that there would be a fulfillment of what was spoken to her from the Lord.”

c. The birth of Jesus (Luke 2:6-7)

And while **they** [*i.e. Joseph and Mary*] were there, the time came for her to give birth. And she gave birth to her firstborn **son** and wrapped him in swaddling cloths and laid him in a **manger**, because there was no place for them in the inn.

Note the ribbon held by the angel above: ‘Glory to God in the highest’ (see v. 14 below)

d. The shepherds (Luke 2:8-20)

And in the same region there were **shepherds out in the field**, keeping watch over their flock by night. And **an angel of the Lord** appeared to them, and the glory of the Lord shone around them, and they were filled with great fear. And the angel said to them, “Fear not, for behold, I bring you good news of great joy that will be for all the people. For unto you is born this day in the city of David a Savior, who is Christ the Lord. And this will be a sign for you: you will find a baby wrapped in swaddling cloths and lying in a manger.” And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the

heavenly host praising God and saying, “**Glory to God in the highest**, and on earth peace among those with whom he is pleased!” When the angels went away from them into heaven, the shepherds said to one another, “Let us go over to Bethlehem and see this thing that has happened, which the Lord has made known to us.” And they went with haste and found Mary and Joseph, and the baby lying in a manger. And when they saw it, they made known the saying that had been told them concerning this child. And all who heard it wondered at what the shepherds told them. But Mary treasured up all these things, pondering them in her heart. And the shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all they had heard and seen, as it had been told them.

The ribbon under the angel says ‘Gloria in excels’, which is probably shortened from ‘Gloria in excelsis Deo’ (Latin for "Glory to God in the highest", v. 14)

Meaning:

The birth of Jesus was accompanied with much human and angelic joy!

Note:

The narrative of Luke's Gospel continues in Window 26.

Window 25, though, tells of the next chronological event, namely the visit of the wise men.

25. The wise men (Matthew 2:1-11)



[a, b, c, d]

2 Now after Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judea in the days of Herod the king, behold, [Window b:] **wise men from the east came to Jerusalem,** ² saying, “Where is he who has been born king of the Jews? [Window a:] **For we saw his star when it rose** and have come to worship him.” ³ When Herod the king heard this, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him; ⁴ and assembling all the chief priests and scribes of the people, he inquired of them where the Christ was to be born. ⁵ They told him, “In Bethlehem of Judea, for so it is written by the prophet:

⁶ “ ‘And you, O Bethlehem, in the land of Judah,

are by no means least among the rulers of Judah;
for from you shall come a ruler
who will shepherd my people Israel.’ ”

[Window c:] ⁷ **Then Herod summoned the wise men** secretly and ascertained from them what time the star had appeared. ⁸ And he sent them to Bethlehem, saying, “Go and search diligently for the child, and when you have found him, bring me word, that I too may come and worship him.” ⁹ After listening to the king, they went on their way. And behold, the star that they had seen when it rose went before them until it came to rest over the place where the child was. ¹⁰ When they saw the star, they rejoiced exceedingly with great joy. [Window d:] ¹¹ And going into the house **they saw the child with Mary his mother, and they fell down and worshiped him. Then, opening their treasures, they offered him gifts, gold and frankincense and myrrh.**

Meaning:

The ‘wise men’ were foreigners to Israel. Yet in guiding them to Jesus by a star, God was bringing his Saviour into the world for the whole world, not just Israel. King Herod felt threatened by this new king, and wanted to use the wise men to locate the boy (so that Herod could dispose of him). Upon finding the boy Jesus, the wise men did not merely pay their respects to him as a king, but worshipped him.

Message:

Is our response to Jesus like that of the wise men, or of Herod?

Note:

The next event in Matthew's Gospel is depicted in Window 26, light b.

26. Boy Jesus



[a+... (b) ...+c+d]⁴⁶

a. In the temple⁴⁷

2:²² And when the time came for their purification according to the Law of Moses, they brought him up to Jerusalem to present him to the Lord²³ (as it is written in the Law of the Lord, “Every male who first opens the womb shall be called holy to the

⁴⁶ Lights **a**, **c**, **d** form one continuous narrative from the Gospel of Luke. It is not known why light **b** is inserted between them.

⁴⁷ Traditionally “the Presentation in the Temple”.

Lord”)²⁴ and to offer a sacrifice according to what is said in the Law of the Lord, “a pair of turtledoves, or two young pigeons.”²⁵ Now there was a man in Jerusalem, whose name was Simeon, and this man was righteous and devout, waiting for the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was upon him.²⁶ And it had been revealed to him by the Holy Spirit that he would not see death before he had seen the Lord's Christ.²⁷ And he came in the Spirit into the temple, and when the parents brought in the child Jesus, to do for him according to the custom of the Law,²⁸ he took him up in his arms and blessed God and said,

²⁹ “Lord, now you are letting your servant depart in peace, according to your word;³⁰ for my eyes have seen your salvation³¹ that you have prepared in the presence of all peoples,³² a light for revelation to the Gentiles, and for glory to your people Israel.”

³³ And his father and his mother marveled at what was said about him.³⁴ And Simeon blessed them and said to Mary his mother, “Behold, this child is appointed for the fall and rising of many in Israel, and for a sign that is opposed³⁵ (and a sword will pierce through your own soul also), so that thoughts from many hearts may be revealed.”

³⁶ And there was a prophetess, Anna, the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Asher. She was advanced in years, having lived with her husband seven years from when she was a virgin,³⁷ and then as a widow until she was eighty-four. She did not depart from the temple, worshiping with fasting and prayer night and day.³⁸ And coming up at that very hour she began to give thanks to God and to speak of him to all who were waiting for the redemption of Jerusalem.

³⁹ And when they had performed everything according to the Law of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to their own town of Nazareth.

c. The visit to Jerusalem

⁴⁰ And the child grew and became strong, filled with wisdom. And the favor of God was upon him.⁴¹ Now his parents went to Jerusalem every year at the Feast of the Passover.⁴² And when he was twelve years old, they went up according to custom.

d. Jesus in the temple

⁴³ And when the feast was ended, as they were returning, the boy Jesus stayed behind in Jerusalem. His parents did not know it,⁴⁴ but supposing him to be in the group they went a day's journey, but then they began to search for him among their relatives and acquaintances,⁴⁵ and when they did not find him, they returned to Jerusalem, searching for him.⁴⁶ After three days they found him in the temple,

sitting among the teachers, listening to them and asking them questions.⁴⁷ And all who heard him were amazed at his understanding and his answers.⁴⁸ And when his parents saw him, they were astonished. And his mother said to him, "Son, why have you treated us so? Behold, your father and I have been searching for you in great distress."⁴⁹ And he said to them, "Why were you looking for me? Did you not know that I must be in my Father's house?"

Meaning:

The temple was highly significant to the Jews; it was the place of their worship and encounter with God. Simeon and Anna were privileged to see the Saviour of Israel during their lifetime; note that Simeon prophesied also the child would be a light to the nations, not just Israel. He also hinted at the kind of death the boy will die. We learn also of Jesus' understanding of his identity as a boy, calling the temple his Father's house.

Note:

This window is a continuation from Window 24. Window 25, telling of the wise men according to Matthew, had been inserted so that the three windows tell the story of Jesus' birth and boyhood chronologically.

Meaning:

King Herod sought to kill this new boy king. God protected his Son by sending an angel (messenger) to instruct Joseph to flee.

Note:

This light is a continuation from Matthew's Gospel in window 25. It has been inserted at this point for chronological reasons.

b. Escape to Egypt "the Flight into Egypt" (Matthew 2:13-15)

¹³ Now when they had departed, behold, **an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream** and said, "Rise, **take the child and his mother, and flee to Egypt**, and remain there until I tell you, for Herod is about to search for the child, to destroy him."¹⁴ And he rose and took the child and his mother by night and departed to Egypt¹⁵ and remained there until the death of Herod. This was to fulfill what the Lord had spoken by the prophet, "Out of Egypt I called my son."

Endnotes

Editions:

The latest edition of this document can be found at tiny.cc/SACwindows
A single-page map of the windows can be found at tiny.cc/SACwindowsmini

Credits:

Thanks to Adrian Leung and Marcus Lim for photography.

Historical Notes:

St Andrew's Cathedral was consecrated on Monday 30 November, 1868.
On that day, the Sydney Morning Herald published, on page 2, a description of the Cathedral.⁴⁸
On the following day (Tuesday 1 December), it published, on page 5, a report of the consecration ceremony.⁴⁹

A contemporary academic wrote:

"From 1861 to 1868 Hardman of Birmingham made windows for St Andrew's Cathedral in Sydney, built in 1837-68, mainly to Edmund Blacket's design. The windows form a rich narrative scheme which covers the major events of Christ's life. Harman's strength in handling large compositions is evident particularly in the twenty-one-light window which features the life of St Andrew."⁵⁰

Vision:

I was privileged to be a Student Minister at St Andrew's Cathedral in 2013-14. In that capacity I spoke with many visitors to the Cathedral who expressed admiration at the building. I quickly taught myself some of its history, with the goal of using it as a segue to sharing the gospel. I suggested that members of the congregations do the same, but I soon realised their knowledge of the building was almost non-existent. In one sense we can be thankful that the

beautiful building is not a distraction to the priority of the gospel, but then I noticed the windows...

What I admire about the windows is that they tell the gospel, unlike many other church building windows in the world. We have an opportunity not to be missed. Whilst studying Australian church history at Moore College I acquired some historical research skills, and decided to apply them to researching the Cathedral windows. This has taken me to archives in the State Library, the SMH archives, long-term tour guides of the Cathedral, and to some academics. My goal in all this research, however, has been to produce an accurate guide to a *biblical* understanding of the window depictions. To that end you will notice that the photographs have been cropped to remove the peripheral, leaving only the content.

This project was undertaken in spare time over approximately eight months. I won't have time to do more beyond this document. However, I have a vision that I would like someone to take up. I would like the material in this document be converted into a smartphone 'app'. I envisage a QR code be prominently displayed at the Cathedral entrances during visiting hours, enabling visitors to freely download their own self-guided tour of the windows, and to hear/read the gospel. For example, this document can be downloaded here:



May God use this resource to bring people to a saving faith in the Lord Jesus Christ.

⁴⁸ <http://trove.nla.gov.au/ndp/del/article/13176487>

⁴⁹ <http://trove.nla.gov.au/ndp/del/article/13176581>

⁵⁰ Beverley Sherry and Douglass Baglin, *Australia's Historic Stained Glass* (Sydney: Murray Child, 1991), 91.